

PRODUCT REQUIREMENT DOCUMENT

MINDBOOK

LAGOS, NIGERIA

Introduction

Mental well-being remains an overlooked aspect of everyday life for many Nigerians. Financial pressures, academic demands, career uncertainty, family responsibilities, and societal stigma often prevent people from seeking emotional support, even when they need it. While awareness of mental health is gradually increasing, access to affordable, trusted, and judgment-free support remains limited.

Many people experience feelings such as anxiety, loneliness, stress, grief, burnout, or emotional overwhelm but do not know where to turn. Existing social platforms are designed primarily for social interaction rather than meaningful emotional support, while professional therapy can be inaccessible due to cost, availability, or stigma.

Mindbook is a community-driven emotional wellness platform designed to ensure that no one has to face life's challenges alone. By combining supportive communities, anonymous sharing, emotional check-ins, guided resources, and access to people who have experienced similar journeys, Mindbook creates a safe digital space where users can receive encouragement, build resilience, and grow emotionally at every stage of their journey.

Problem Statement

Many Nigerians experience emotional challenges such as stress, anxiety, loneliness, grief, burnout, and relationship difficulties, yet lack access to safe, affordable, and judgment-free spaces where they can seek support, share their experiences, and connect with people who truly understand what they are going through. Existing social platforms are not designed for emotional well-being, while professional mental health services remain inaccessible or underutilized for many due to cost, stigma, and limited availability.

Proposed Solution

Mindbook is a mobile application designed to provide users with a safe, private, and supportive environment for emotional wellness.

The app enables users to complete daily emotional check-ins, join moderated Circles based on shared life experiences and emotional journeys, share experiences anonymously or openly, receive encouragement from peers and verified Guides, and access curated emotional wellness resources.

Unlike traditional social media platforms that prioritize engagement, Mindbook is intentionally designed to foster meaningful conversations, emotional safety, and personal growth. Through intelligent recommendations, the app connects users to relevant communities, resources, and support based on their current emotional state and ongoing life experiences.

Primary Target Audience (MVP)

- University students
- NYSC members
- Young professionals
- Job seekers
- Entrepreneurs
- Remote workers

Secondary Target Audience

- Individuals who have recovered from burnout
- People who have healed from heartbreak
- Individuals managing anxiety successfully
- Those who have navigated grief
- Parents who have overcome postpartum challenges
- People passionate about peer support

Future Target Audience

- Licensed psychologists
- Therapists
- Counsellors
- Faith-based counsellors
- Wellness coaches

Objectives

- Create a safe, private, and inclusive digital environment where users can openly express their emotions without fear of judgment.
- Enable users to connect with supportive communities (Circles) based on shared life experiences and emotional journeys rather than temporary emotions alone.
- Reduce feelings of isolation by helping users build meaningful peer connections and receive encouragement from verified Guides and community members.
- Foster healthy, respectful, and supportive interactions through moderation, reporting tools, and community guidelines.
- Build a trusted emotional wellness platform that complements, not replaces professional mental health care.

Scope of Work

In Scope (MVP)

The first version of Mindbook will focus on building a secure and supportive emotional wellness platform with the following features:

User Authentication

- User registration
- Login and logout
- Password reset
- Profile creation

User Onboarding

- Welcome screens
- Emotional wellness introduction
- Community guidelines
- Initial emotional check-in
- Journey stage selection (Seeking Support, Healing, or Guiding)

Daily Emotional Check-ins

- Daily mood selection

- Mood history
- Personalized recommendations based on check-ins

Circles (Communities)

- Browse and join multiple Circles
- Public and private Circles
- Community discussions
- Anonymous and identified posting
- Comments and reactions

Journey-Based Experience

Users can identify their current stage:

- Seeking Support
- Healing
- Guiding Others

Community Safety

- Report posts and comments
- Block users
- Community guidelines
- Moderator dashboard
- Content moderation tools

Notifications

- Daily emotional check-in reminders
- Replies to posts
- Community updates

Profile Management

- Edit profile
- Privacy settings
- Mood history
- Joined Circles
- Logout

- Delete account

Out of Scope (Future Releases)

The following features are not included in Version 1:

- AI emotional companion
- Therapist video consultations
- Voice and video community rooms
- Live streaming
- Group voice calls
- Marketplace
- Courses
- Corporate wellness portal
- Church communities
- University communities
- Premium subscriptions
- Emotional analytics dashboard
- AI-powered matching
- Smart recommendations using machine learning
- Wearable device integration
- Multi-language support

Key Features

What are the key features expected in the proposed MVP?

Version	Feature Area	Mobile APP	Back Office
MVP -1.0	User Authentication	User Registration, Login, Logout, Forgot Password	Manage user accounts, suspend/reactivate users
MVP -1.0	User Onboarding	Welcome screens, Community	Configure onboarding content and

		Guidelines, Privacy Consent, Journey Stage Selection, First Emotional Check-in	community guidelines
MVP -1.0	User Profile	Create/Edit Profile, Privacy Settings, Mood History, Joined Circles, Delete Account	View user profiles and account status
MVP -1.0	Daily Emotional Check-ins	Daily mood selection, Mood history, Personalized recommendations	View anonymous emotional trends and engagement analytics
MVP -1.0	Circles (Communities)	Browse Circles, Join Multiple Circles, Leave Circles, View Circle Feed	Create, edit, archive and manage Circles
MVP -1.0	Community Feed	Create Posts, Anonymous Posts, Comments, Reactions, Success Stories, Questions, Encouragement Posts	Remove inappropriate posts, pin important announcements
MVP -1.0	Journey Stages	Users identify as Seeking Support, Healing, or Guiding	Assign, verify or review Guide status where applicable
MVP -1.0	Notifications	Daily check-in reminders, Replies, Community updates	Send announcements and notification campaigns
MVP -1.0	Safety & Moderation	Report Users, Report Posts, Block Users, Community Guidelines	Review reports, moderate content, suspend users, manage moderators
MVP -1.0	Search	Search Circles, and Topics	Manage searchable categories and keywords
MVP -1.0	Settings	Privacy Settings, Change Password, Log Out, Delete Account	Configure platform settings and moderation policies

Mindbook MVP – User Flow

Download & Account Creation

The user downloads the Mindbook app from the App Store or Google Play Store.

The user creates an account by providing:

- Email Address
- Password

The user verifies their email address and signs in.



Create Your Anonymous Identity

To protect users' privacy, Mindbook allows every user to interact using an anonymous identity.

The user chooses:

- A Display Name (e.g., HopefulSoul, BraveHeart, StillHealing)
- An Avatar

Note: A user's email address and real identity are never visible to other members. Only their chosen display name and avatar are displayed throughout the app.



.Welcome to Mindbook

The user is welcomed with a short introduction.

Welcome to Mindbook.

Do life alone? Nah.

A safe space where you can share, heal, grow, and support others through life's challenges.

The user taps **Continue**.



Community Guidelines

Before using the platform, the user reviews and accepts:

- Community Guidelines
- Privacy Policy

- Terms & Conditions



What Would You Like Support With?

To personalize the user's experience, Mindbook asks the user to select one or more topics they would like support with.

Examples include:

- Relationships
- Men's Issues
- Women's Issues
- Career
- School
- Anxiety
- Loneliness
- Family
- Financial Stress
- Faith
- Healing
- Other

The user may select multiple topics.



Personalized Community Recommendations

Based on the selected topics, Mindbook recommends relevant Communities.

For example:

- Relationship Community
- Men's Community
- Faith Community
- Healing Community

The user can:

- Join one Community
- Join multiple Communities
- Skip and explore later



Choose How You'd Like to Participate

Before joining a Circle, the user is asked:

"What brings you to this Community today?"

The user selects one of two action buttons. (Seeking Support/ supporting others)

SEEKING SUPPORT

I'm currently going through this experience and would like support from people who understand.

SUPPORTING OTHERS

I've experienced something similar and would like to encourage and support others.

This choice is not permanent and can be changed at any time from the user's profile.



Automatic Circle Assignment

Mindbook automatically assigns the user to a private Circle within the selected Community.

Each Circle contains **5–10 members** to encourage meaningful conversations and genuine relationships.

Each Circle is intentionally balanced with members who are:

- Seeking Support
- Supporting Others

As the platform grows, some Circles may also include a **Verified Guide** who helps encourage healthy discussions. Moderators oversee multiple Circles to ensure community safety.

Note: If a Circle reaches its maximum capacity, the user is automatically assigned to another available Circle within the same Community.



Home Feed

The user is taken to their personalized Home Feed.

The Home Feed includes:

- A personalized greeting
- "What's going on with you today?" post composer
- Recent posts from the user's joined Communities and Circles
- Recommended Communities
- Emotional wellness resources
- Community updates

This is where the user creates their first post.



Community Experience

Selecting a Community opens the Community page.

The Community page displays:

- Community description
- Number of active Circles
- Number of members
- Featured resources
- Community announcements
- Community feed

Users can explore the wider Community while primarily interacting within their assigned Circle.



Circle Experience

The Circle is the user's primary support space.

Each Circle consists of **5–10 members** with similar experiences and a healthy balance of members seeking and offering support.

Inside the Circle, members can:

- Share personal experiences
- Ask questions
- Encourage one another
- Celebrate milestones
- Discuss challenges
- Participate in guided conversations

Because of the small group size, members gradually build trust and familiarity through regular interaction.



Creating a Post

When the user taps "*What's going on with you today?*", they are guided before publishing.

The user first selects the purpose of the post:

- I Need Support
- I Need Advice
- I Want to Encourage Someone
- I Want to Share My Story
- Prayer Request

The user then writes their post.

Finally, they choose the audience:

- My Circle
- Entire Community
- Moderators Only

Because every user has an anonymous profile, their real identity is never shown to other members.



Community Engagement

Users can:

- Comment on posts
- React to posts
- Encourage other members
- Save helpful posts
- Report inappropriate content

Verified Guides help encourage positive conversations, while moderators review reports and enforce community guidelines.



Daily Check-In

Each day, users return to their Home Feed, where they are invited to share again through the question:

"What's going on with you today?"

Users can:

- Share new experiences
- Continue existing conversations
- Join additional Communities if their needs change
- Switch between Seeking Support and Supporting Others



Personal Growth

As users continue engaging with Mindbook, they may naturally move from seeking support to supporting others.

Members who consistently demonstrate empathy, kindness, and positive engagement may apply to become **Verified Guides** after completing Guide training and platform review.



Profile & Settings

Users can:

- Edit their anonymous display name
- Change their avatar
- View joined Communities
- View assigned Circles
- Switch between **Seeking Support** and **Supporting Others**
- Manage privacy settings
- View activity history
- Log out
- Delete their account

Dependencies & Prerequisites

Technical Infrastructure

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Legal and Compliance

- The site must comply with Nigeria's Data Protection Act (NDPA) and applicable global frameworks such as the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). User consent mechanisms, data encryption, access logs, and opt-out features must be built into the design.
- A clear and legally sound Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, and Cookie Policy must be drafted and published before user registration begins.
- All media assets, alumni profiles, and learning resources must be vetted to avoid IP infringement. Licensing or release permissions should be obtained where necessary.
- All financial transactions (e.g., donations) must be audited-ready, with payment logs, receipts, and refund policies clearly implemented and communicated.

User Base & Feedback Mechanisms

- The alumni relations office must provide a clean, verified list of alumni with relevant metadata (e.g., graduation year, industry, region). This dataset should be GDPR/NDPA compliant and securely stored.

- Selected alumni should be involved in the User Acceptance Testing (UAT) phase. Their insights will refine usability, relevance, and tone.
- Feedback forms, in-app surveys, contact support, and live chat (where applicable) should be embedded into the platform to capture ongoing sentiment and suggestions.
- For user-generated content (class notes, spotlights), clear moderation rules and workflows must be in place to prevent misuse and maintain professionalism.